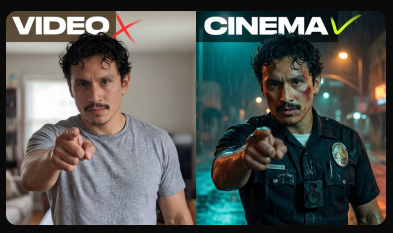
HIGGSFIELD PLAYBOOK — VOL. 2

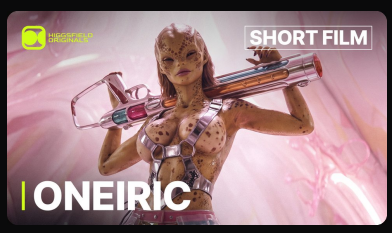
5 HIGH-CTR THUMBNAIL FRAMEWORKS

THE FIVE STRUCTURES WE RELY ON MOST

The five thumbnail structures we rely on most at Higgsfield. Each one answers the same question a different way: what makes a viewer stop scrolling and need to know more? Sketch several variants per video, judge them side by side at feed size, and keep the one that raises a question the title doesn't fully answer.







FRAMEWORK 01

BEFORE/AFTER

- Two states of one subject in a single frame — the raw starting point on one side, the finished result on the other — so the contrast does the selling before a single word is read.
- The click lives in the gap between the halves: green-screen footage next to a finished VFX shot promises a process the viewer hasn't seen yet.
- Keep pose, framing and lighting identical across both sides so the result is the only variable; verdict labels ("VIDEO × / CINEMA ✓") make the comparison land in under a second.





FRAMEWORK 02

MID ACTION SHOTS

- Freeze the story at its peak — a body mid-fall, a blast mid-detonation, a face inches from the lens. An unresolved moment forces the click: the viewer needs to see the resolution.
- One action per thumbnail. Motion blur, debris, expression — everything in the frame serves that single moment; anything else is noise.
- Re-staging or enhancing the frame after the shoot is fair game, as long as it stays true to what actually happens in the video.





FRAMEWORK 03

RECOGNIZABLE LOGOS

- Recognizable logos are shortcuts: in a fraction of a second the viewer knows exactly which tools the video revolves around — before reading a single word.
- The hook is the tension between the logos and the claim beside them: “$1280/day” next to two app icons, or an editing suite paired with “AI + Real Footage”, leaves exactly one question — how?
- Two or three big, clean logos maximum, and only combinations the video actually delivers on — a misleading pairing buys one click and costs credibility.





FRAMEWORK 04

3 STEP PROGRESSION

- Three frames, one journey: where it started, the turning point, and the payoff. The middle frame is what separates this from a plain before/after — it teases the process, not just the outcome.
- The middle beat must raise a question of its own; if the second frame is just “halfway done”, the sequence has no pull.
- Same subject, same angle, read left to right — the whole arc should land in under a second, no caption required.

EXAMPLE TO BE GENERATED

Three frames, same subject, same angle: start — turning point — payoff.

FRAMEWORK 05

COMPELLING SCREENSHOTS

- Sometimes the strongest thumbnail is already inside the video: a real frame carries an authenticity no composed graphic can fake.
- Scrub the footage for the shot whose energy matches the title's promise — the still should feel like the whole video compressed into one image.
- Pick a frame close to how the video opens, so the first seconds confirm exactly what the thumbnail promised.





